没有到来的零日

The Day Zero That Never Came



开普敦怎样避开了水龙头大范围关闭的零日？

英文原文

In January 2018, Cape Town **issued** a **stark alert**: Day Zero could arrive in April. The term **denoted** a **grim threshold**, reached when water in the city's **reservoirs**, as a **percentage** of **capacity**, fell to 13.5 per cent. Most taps would then be shut, and **residents** would queue at about 200 **designated** collection points.

The **prospect** was **genuine**. Three **consecutive** years of **meagre** rainfall, from 2015 to 2017, had **diminished** the reservoirs serving a **metropolitan** area of about four million people. By early 2018 the **dams** were **roughly** a fifth full. The **countdown** turned a **chronic shortage** into an **imminent** deadline.

The city paired **mandatory restrictions** with **unprecedented transparency**. From 1 February 2018, each person was **allotted** 50 **litres** a day. **Officials disclosed** dam levels and **household consumption**; the published **tallies** made **thrift visible** and let neighbours **benchmark** their use. Daily use was more than **halved**, from about 1.2 billion litres in 2015 to about 500 million by early 2018.

Other forces **intervened**. In February 2018, **upstream** farmers released water from their **irrigation** dams; with farms drawing less, Day Zero was **postponed** to July. In March 2018, officials judged Day Zero **unlikely** that year. Winter rains **subsequently replenished** the reservoirs, which were about half full by July. The 50-litre limit was **eased** in October 2018.

The **burden**, critics argued, fell **unevenly**. **Townships**, poor areas **segregated** by race under **apartheid**, had long made do with **scant** water, yet **steeper tariffs squeezed** them hardest. Others blamed **alarmist** warnings for tourist **cancellations**. Households, farmers, and rain kept the collection points **idle**, but the **sacrifice** weighed heaviest on those with the least to give.

中文译文

2018年1月，开普敦发出了一则严峻的警报，称零日可能在4月到来。这个词指的是一道严酷的门槛：即当该市水库的存水按占水库容量的百分比降至13.5%时达到的门槛。大部分水龙头届时将被关闭，居民要到约200个指定的取水点排队取水。

这一前景是真实存在的。连续三年贫乏的降雨，从2015到2017年，减少了水库的蓄水，这些水库给一个大都市区供水，大约400万人口。到2018年初，水库只剩约五分之一的蓄水。倒计时把一场长期的短缺变成了一个迫在眉睫的最后期限。

该市把强制性的限制措施与前所未有的透明度结合起来。自2018年2月1日起，每人被分配每天50升水。官员们公布水库水位和家庭消耗量；公开的统计数字让节俭成效一目了然，也让邻里之间得以对标他们的用水量。日常的用水量减少了一半以上，从2015年的约12亿升降至2018年初的约5亿升。

其他力量也介入了。2018年2月，上游的农民从他们的灌溉水坝中放出了水；加上农场用水减少，零日被推迟到7月。2018年3月，官员们判断零日不太可能在当年发生。冬雨随后重新装满了各水库，到7月时水库已约半满。50升的限额于2018年10月放宽。

批评者认为，负担分配得并不均衡。城镇区，在种族隔离制度下按种族被隔离出来的贫困地区，长期以来就靠很少的水勉强对付，然而更高的水价最大程度地压榨了他们。另一些人则责备危言耸听的警告，因为这些警告造成了游客取消行程。家庭、农民和雨水让取水点一直闲置，但这份牺牲最沉重地落在了那些最没有能力付出的人身上。

词汇与表达

issued v.
发出了
Cape Town issued a stark alert

stark adj.
严峻的
a stark alert

alert n.
警报

denoted v.
指的是
The term denoted a grim threshold

grim adj.
严酷的

threshold n.
门槛
a grim threshold

reservoirs n.
水库
the city's reservoirs

percentage n.
百分比

capacity n.
容量
as a percentage of capacity

residents n.
居民

designated adj.
指定的
200 designated collection points

prospect n.
前景

genuine adj.
真实存在的

consecutive adj.
连续
Three consecutive years

meagre adj.
贫乏的
meagre rainfall

diminished v.
减少了

metropolitan adj.
大都市

dams n.
水库

roughly adv.
约

词汇与表达（续）

countdown n.
倒计时

chronic adj.
长期的
a chronic shortage

shortage n.
短缺

imminent adj.
迫在眉睫的
an imminent deadline

mandatory adj.
强制性的
mandatory restrictions

restrictions n.
限制措施

unprecedented adj.
前所未有的
unprecedented transparency

transparency n.
透明度
unprecedented transparency

allotted v.
分配
each person was allotted 50 litres

litres n.
升

Officials n.
官员们

disclosed v.
公布

household adj.
家庭

consumption n.
消耗量
household consumption

tallies n.
统计数字

thrift n.
节俭

visible adj.
一目了然

benchmark v.
对标
benchmark their use

halved v.
减少了一半

词汇与表达（续）

intervened v.
介入了

upstream adj.
上游的

irrigation n.
灌溉

postponed v.
推迟
Day Zero was postponed to July

unlikely adj.
不太可能

subsequently adv.
随后

replenished v.
重新装满了
replenished the reservoirs

eased v.
放宽

burden n.
负担
The burden, critics argued

unevenly adv.
并不均衡
fell unevenly

Townships n.
城镇区

segregated v.
隔离

apartheid n.
种族隔离制度

scant adj.
很少的

steeper adj.
更高的

tariffs n.
水价
steeper tariffs squeezed them hardest

squeezed v.
压榨了

alarmist adj.
危言耸听的

cancellations n.
取消行程

idle adj.
闲置

sacrifice v.
牺牲

文章简述

- 危机：连续三年少雨使南非开普敦水库告急。2018年初，当局警告，四月可能迎来大范围停水的“零日”。
- 门槛：零日指蓄水降至总容量的13.5%，届时大部分水龙头关闭，居民必须到指定地点领水。
- 节水：全市日用水量由2015年约12亿升降至2018年初约5亿升；2月起每人每日限用50升，并公开水位及用量。
- 转机：居民节水、上游农民放水，以及农场减少取水，使零日一再推迟；随后冬雨补充水库，避免了当年大范围停水。
- 负担：贫困社区原本用水就少，却最难承受上涨水价。批评者指出，危机虽被避开，节水代价并没有被公平分担。